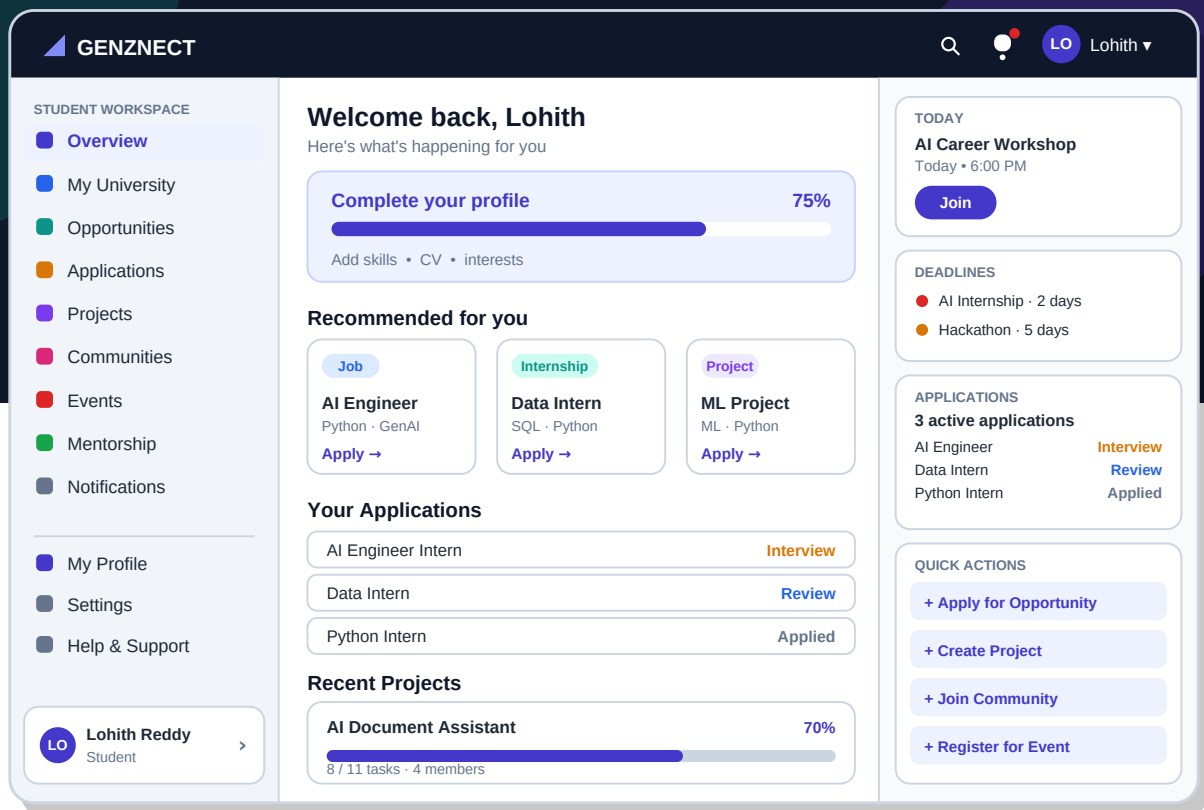


Student Dashboard Blueprint

From an LMS-style portal to a career + opportunity workspace

Sidebar structure · Overview · Right panel · Workflows · Phased roadmap



Based on the GenZnect roadmap, the Community Foundational Guidelines and the reference dashboards

Contents

Every section is listed below and links to its page.

★ Executive Summary	2
1 Recommended GenZnect Student Dashboard	3
2 What Is Wrong with the Current Sample for GenZnect?	4
3 Final Left Sidebar Structure	5
4 Sidebar Header	5
5 Overview	6
6 My University	6
7 Opportunities — The Most Important Sidebar Item	7
8 Opportunity Page	8
9 Applications	8
10 Projects	9
11 Project Workspace	10
12 Communities	10
13 Events	11
14 Mentorship	12
15 Notifications	12
16 Profile	13
17 Settings	13
18 Help & Support	14
19 The Most Important Change: Don't Show Every Submenu Permanently	14
20 Recommended Sidebar Ordering	15
21 Make the Sidebar “Smart”	16
22 Profile Completion Indicator	16
23 Add “For You” Intelligence	17
24 Right Panel — Recommended Design	18
25 Don't Make the Right Panel Too Large	18
26 Make the Dashboard Feel Like a Career Workspace	19
27 Student Engagement Loop	20
28 Your MVP Should NOT Build Everything Yet	21
29 One Important UX Rule	21
30 Final Sidebar I Recommend for Your Current Build	22
31 GenZnect's Sidebar Philosophy	23
★ Recommended Overall Architecture	24

★ Executive Summary

Based on the GenZnect roadmap, the uploaded **Community Foundational Guidelines** and the two reference screenshots, the student dashboard should be redesigned so it feels **less like an LMS / college portal** and **more like a student career + opportunity workspace**.

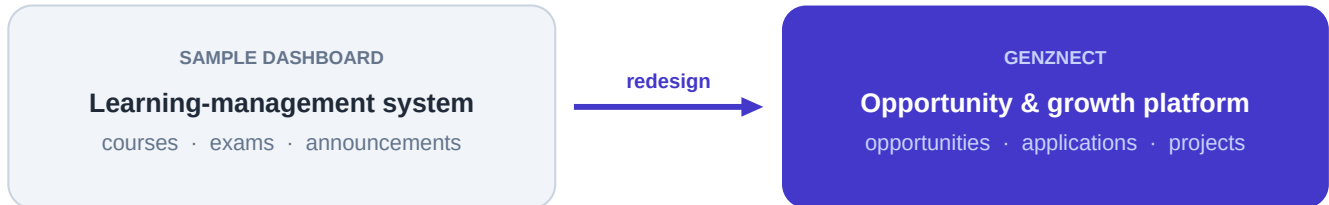


Figure 1 — The shift in product identity

THE KEY DIFFERENCE

The sample dashboard is primarily a **learning-management system**. GenZnect should be an **opportunity-management and student-growth platform**.

The guidelines describe GenZnect as a central platform where students can discover internships, jobs, projects, mentorship, events, training, networking and career opportunities, while also tracking applications, projects, participation and achievements.

The blueprint at a glance

NAVIGATION

Overview, My University, Opportunities, Applications, Projects, Communities, Events, Mentorship, Notifications — then My Profile, Settings, Help & Support.

CENTRAL PRODUCT LOOP

Opportunities → Applications → Projects, supported by Communities, Events and Mentorship to build experience, profile and network.

MVP FIRST

Phase 1: Overview, My University, Opportunities, Applications, Profile, Notifications, Settings. Other modules activate phase by phase.

1 Recommended GenZnect Student Dashboard

The entire screen is structured as a three-column workspace: a persistent navigation sidebar, a main workspace, and a compact contextual panel for today's information.

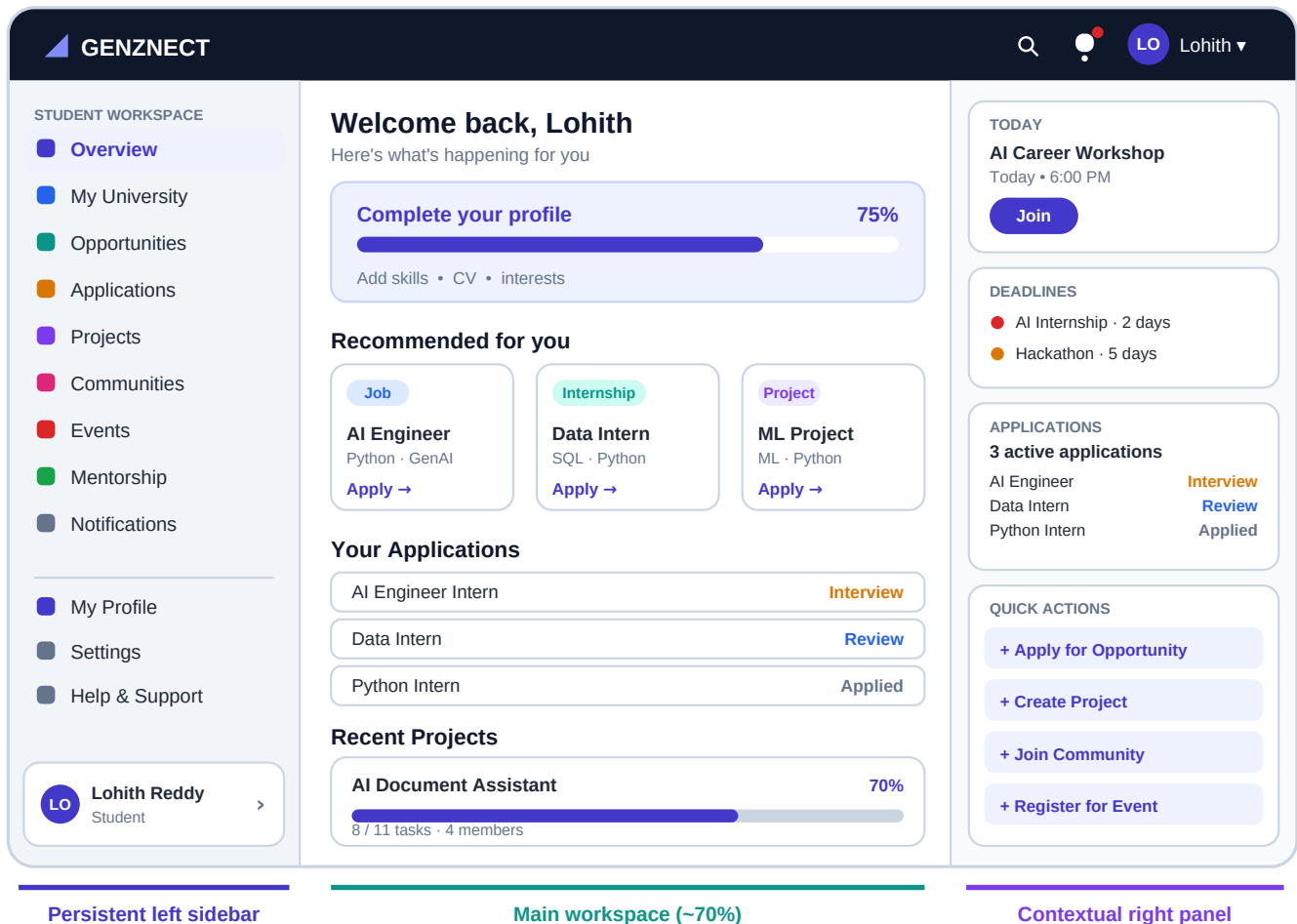


Figure 2 — Recommended layout of the GenZnect student dashboard

The left sidebar should remain **persistent**, while the right panel should be **contextual**.

2 What Is Wrong with the Current Sample for GenZnect?

The first screenshot uses these navigation items: **Home, My Learning, Announcements, Calendar, Exams, Certificates, Help, Settings**. That works well for an education / LMS product. But GenZnect's documented student functionality is different.

SAMPLE (LMS) NAVIGATION	WHAT GENZNECT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO
Home	✓ Create profiles
✗ My Learning	✓ Upload CVs
✗ Announcements (generic)	✓ Select skills / interests
Calendar	✓ Apply for opportunities
✗ Exams	✓ Join projects / events
Certificates	✓ Track applications
Help	✓ Access mentorship
Settings	✓ Complete assessments
	✓ Submit project work
	✓ Earn certificates / badges

THESE SHOULD NOT BE MAIN NAVIGATION ITEMS

✗ My Learning ✗ Exams ✗ Generic Announcements

Instead, the sidebar should answer the student's most important questions

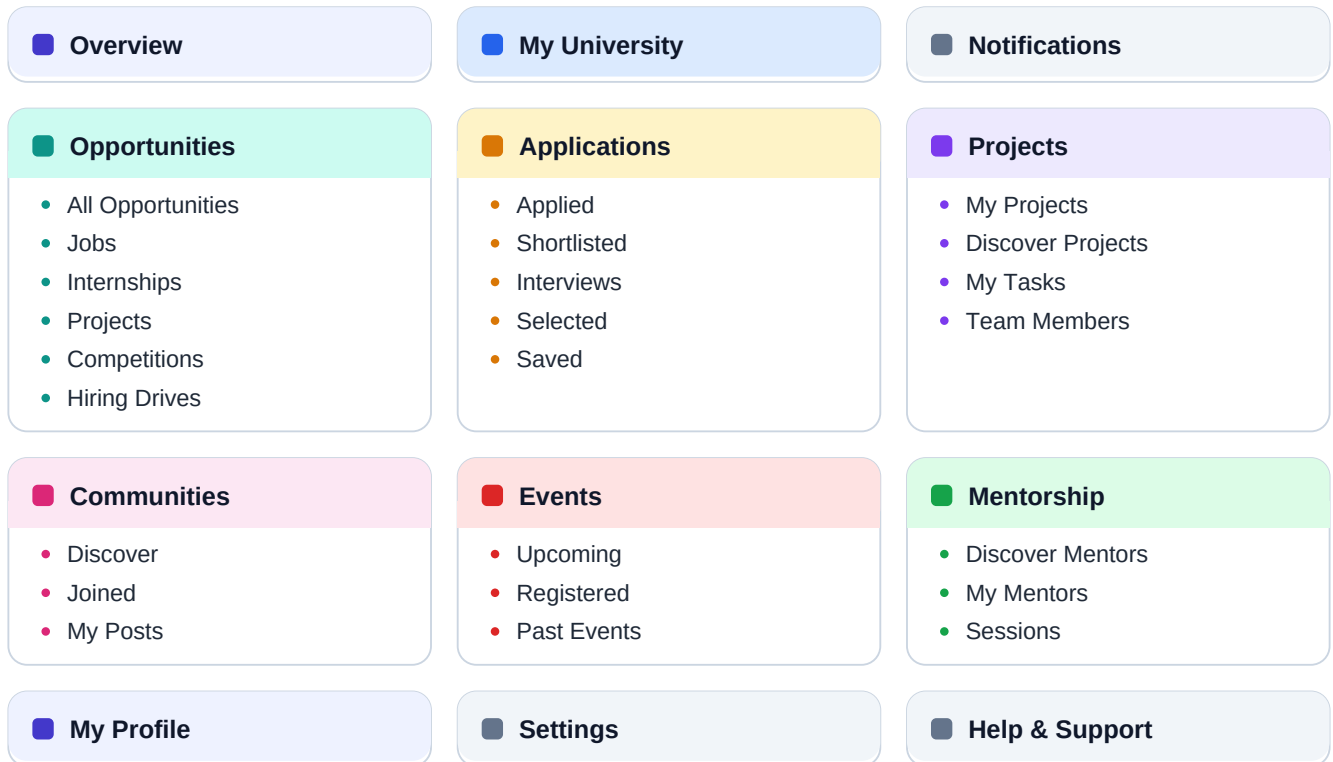
1 What opportunities are available to me?	2 What have I applied for?
3 What am I working on?	4 Who can I connect with?
5 What events are happening?	6 How am I progressing?

Figure 3 — The six questions the navigation should answer

3 Final Left Sidebar Structure

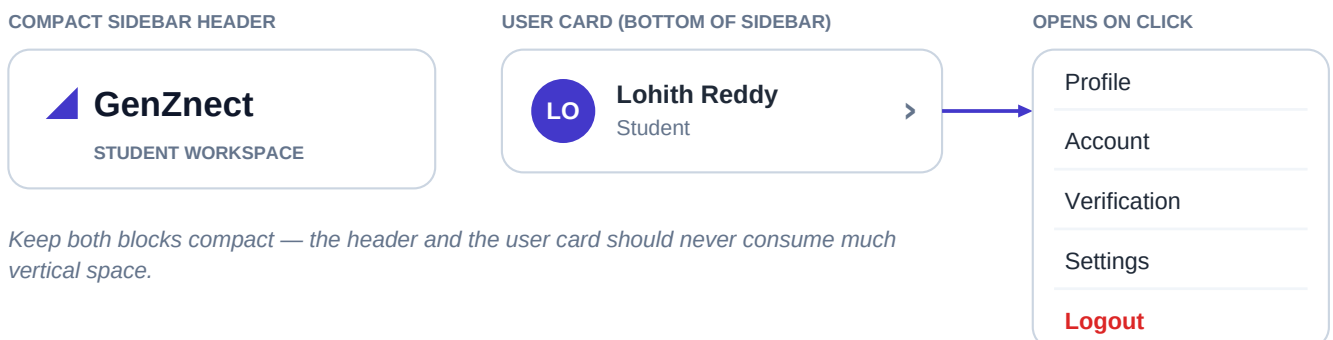
The recommended structure below gives GenZnect a much stronger identity: a first level that mirrors the student's needs, and second-level items that appear only when a section is opened.

GENZNECT · Student Workspace



4 Sidebar Header

Instead of simply showing *GenZnect / Student*, use a compact header reading **GenZnect · Student Workspace**. The signed-in user sits in a compact card at the bottom of the sidebar (**LO — Lohith Reddy — Student**).



Keep both blocks compact — the header and the user card should never consume much vertical space.

Figure 4 — Compact header, bottom user card, and the menu it opens

Clicking the user card opens: **Profile, Account, Verification, Settings, Logout.**

5 Overview

This is the **default page**. Don't call it simply *Home* — **Overview** fits better because GenZnect is a workspace, not a traditional college portal.

The Overview page should show

Good evening, Lohith

Here's what's happening in your GenZnect workspace.

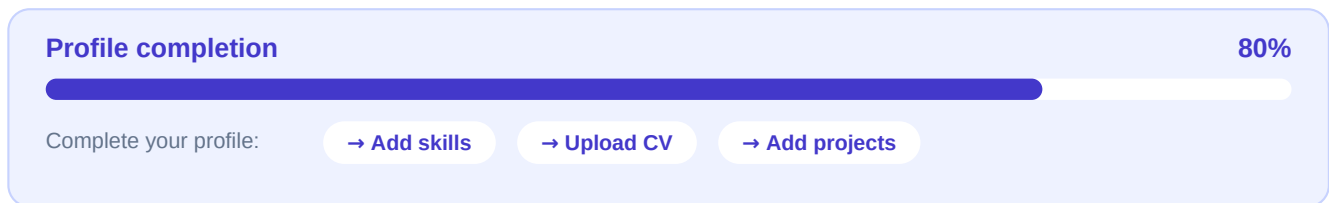


Figure 5 — Header and profile-completion card

This is directly aligned with the onboarding requirements: profile completion, CV, skills, interests, preferred roles, availability and related information.

6 My University

This item is particularly important because GenZnect has **two signup paths**.

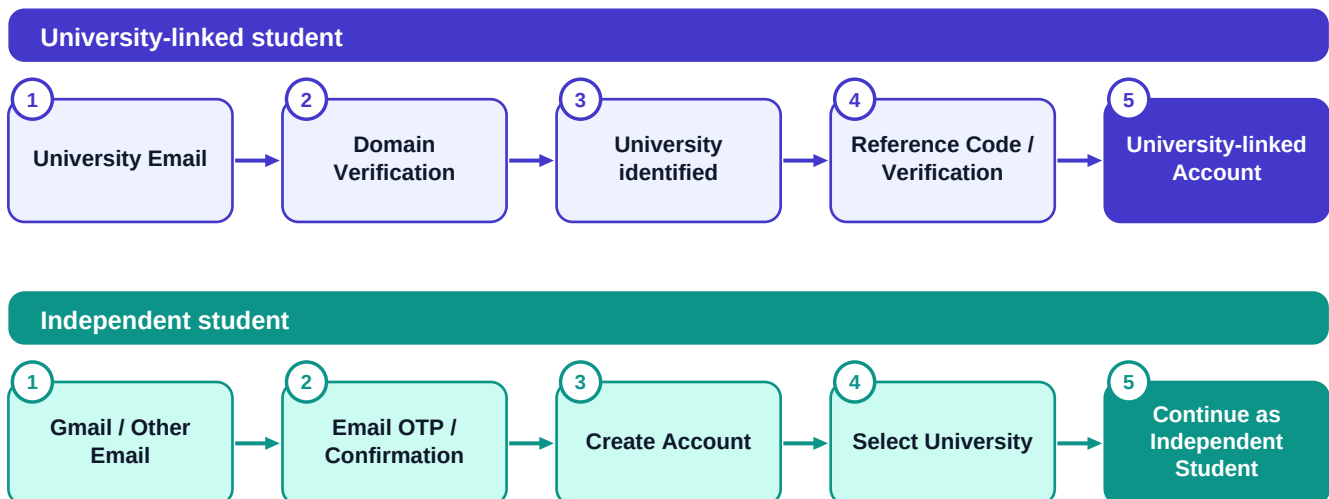


Figure 6 — University-linked vs. independent signup workflows

How the sidebar item should look

The sidebar shouldn't simply say *University*. Use **My University** and change what it shows depending on the account state.

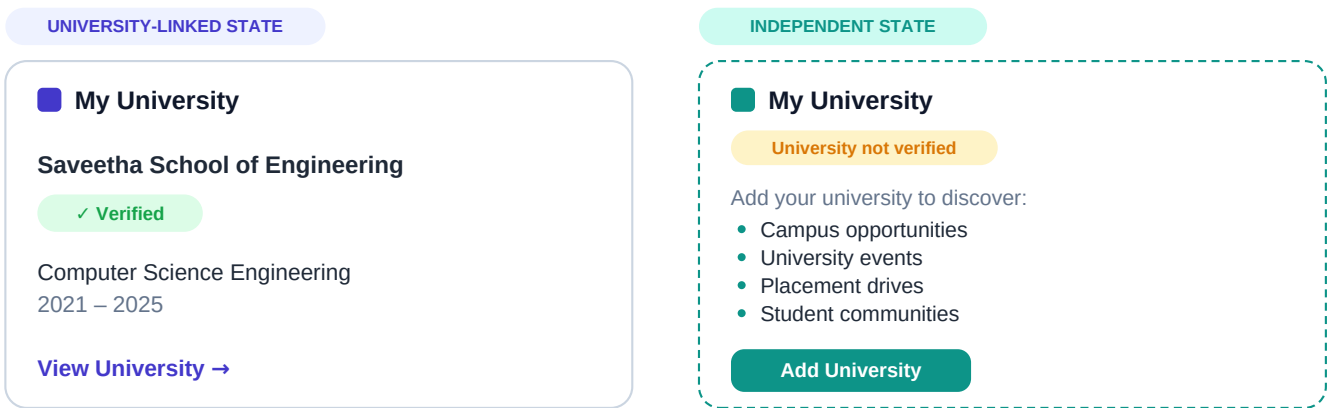


Figure 7 — Two states of the My University block

Possible submenu (university-linked)

University Overview Announcements Events Opportunities Resources Placement Updates

The guidelines specifically mention university events, recruitment drives, industry connections and student participation.

INDEPENDENT STUDENTS

Don't make the independent student feel like a second-class user. Present "Add University" as a way to unlock campus opportunities, events, placement drives and communities — an important principle for the product.

7 Opportunities — The Most Important Sidebar Item

This should be one of the most prominent items. The roadmap says: "Opportunities + applications — browse, filter, apply, track status." The guidelines explicitly describe jobs, internships, projects, recruitment drives and other opportunities.

Submenu

All Opportunities Jobs Internships Projects Competitions Hiring Drives

Potential future additions

Recommended for You Saved Opportunities Closing Soon

8

Opportunity Page

Students should see opportunity cards that surface the key decision facts at a glance.

AI **AI/ML Intern**
ABC Technologies

Hyderabad / Remote

Python ML SQL

Internship • 3 Months

Apply by: 25 Sep

Save Apply Now

- Role and company
- Location / work mode
- Required skills
- Type and duration
- Application deadline
- Save and Apply actions

Figure 8 — Opportunity card

Filters

Search opportunities All

Type

- ☐ Job
- ☐ Internship
- ☐ Project
- ☐ Competition

Skills

- ☐ Python
- ☐ Java
- ☐ AI/ML
- ☐ Data Science
- ☐ Web Development

Location

- ☐ Remote
- ☐ Hyderabad
- ☐ Bengaluru
- ☐ Mumbai

Experience

- ☐ Fresher
- ☐ 0–1 year
- ☐ 1–2 years

Figure 9 — Search and filter panel

9

Applications

This should be a **separate primary navigation item**. Don't hide application tracking inside Opportunities. After applying, the student's behavior changes:



Figure 10 — Why applications need their own section

Submenu

All Applications Applied Shortlisted Interview Selected Rejected Withdrawn

Applications dashboard

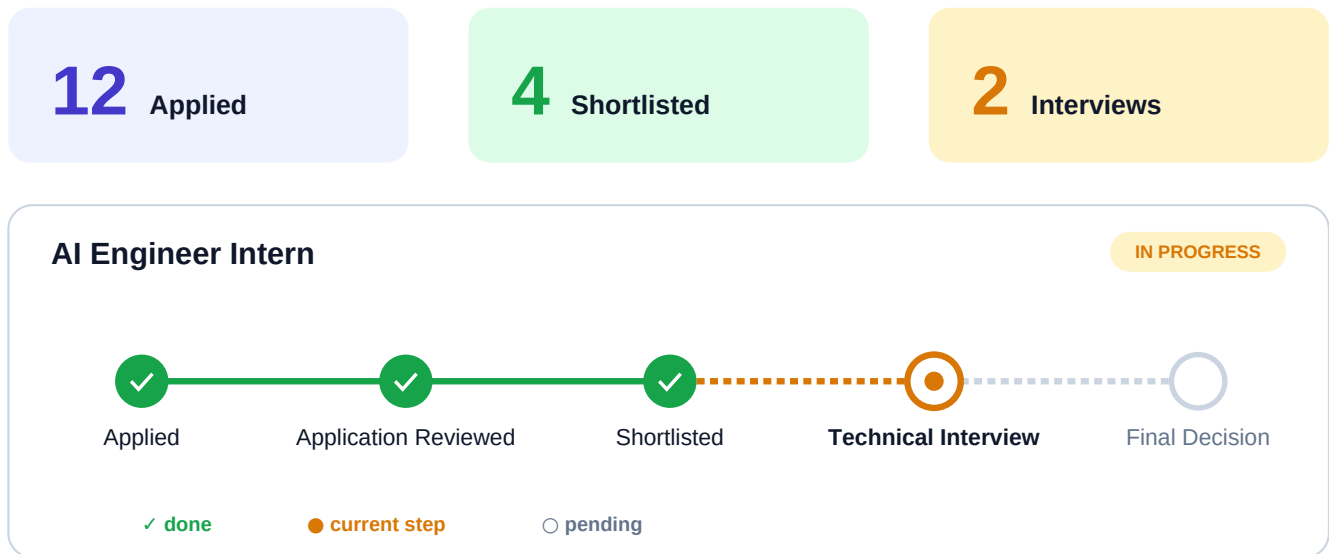
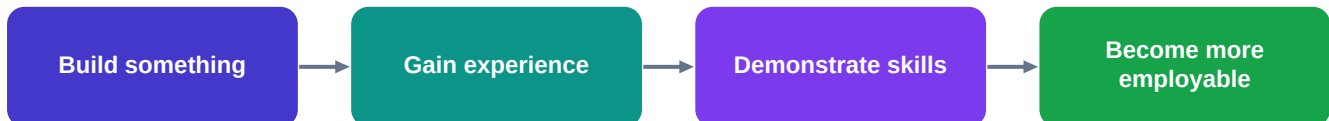


Figure 11 — Status summary and application timeline

The platform guidelines explicitly include application tracking, candidate filtering, interviews and recruitment progress.

10 Projects

Projects should become another major GenZnect identity. The platform isn't just *"find a job"* — it should also let students build something, gain experience, demonstrate skills and become more employable.



MY PROJECTS — EXAMPLE CARD

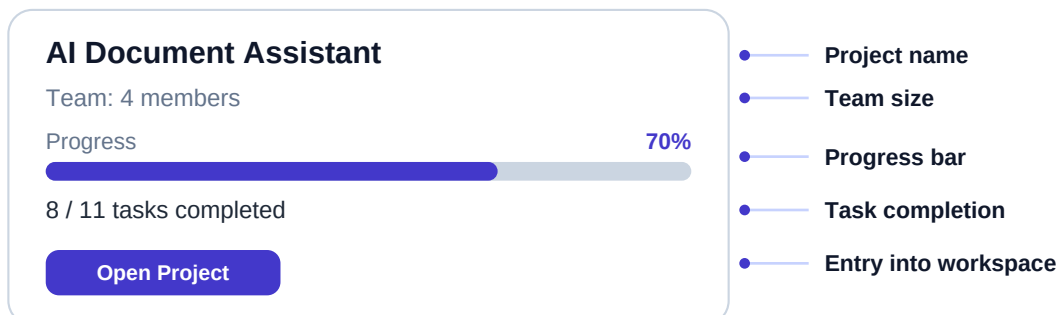


Figure 12 — The project value chain and a "My Projects" card

The guidelines include internal, company-sponsored, university, startup, research and social-impact projects.

Submenu



11 Project Workspace

When the student opens a project, the workspace offers the tabs **Overview** · **Tasks** · **Team** · **Files** · **Activity**, with the task board organized into four stages.

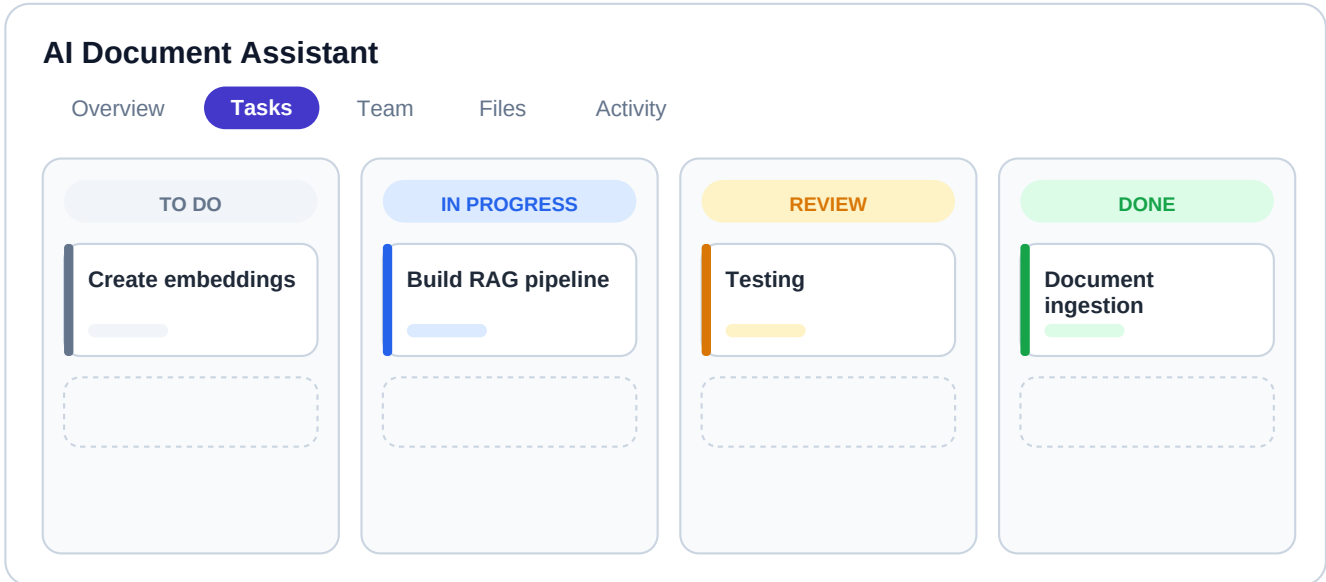


Figure 13 — Project workspace — task board

This directly supports the platform's documented project / task-management direction.

12 Communities

This is where GenZnect differentiates itself from a conventional job portal.

Submenu

Discover Communities

My Communities

Community Feed

My Posts

Example communities

AI & Machine Learning

Python Developers

Cybersecurity

Data Science

Entrepreneurship

Startup Builders

Campus Communities

International Careers

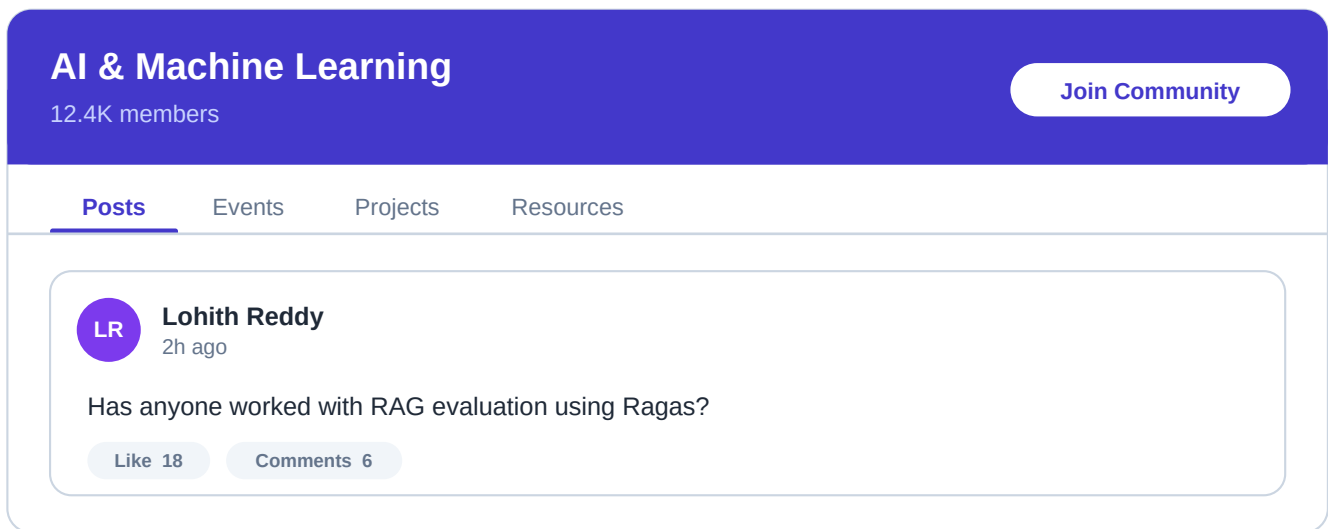


Figure 14 — Community page with feed

The guidelines explicitly describe technical discussions, career questions, networking, mentor interactions and other recurring engagement activities.

13 Events

Events should be another top-level item.

Submenu

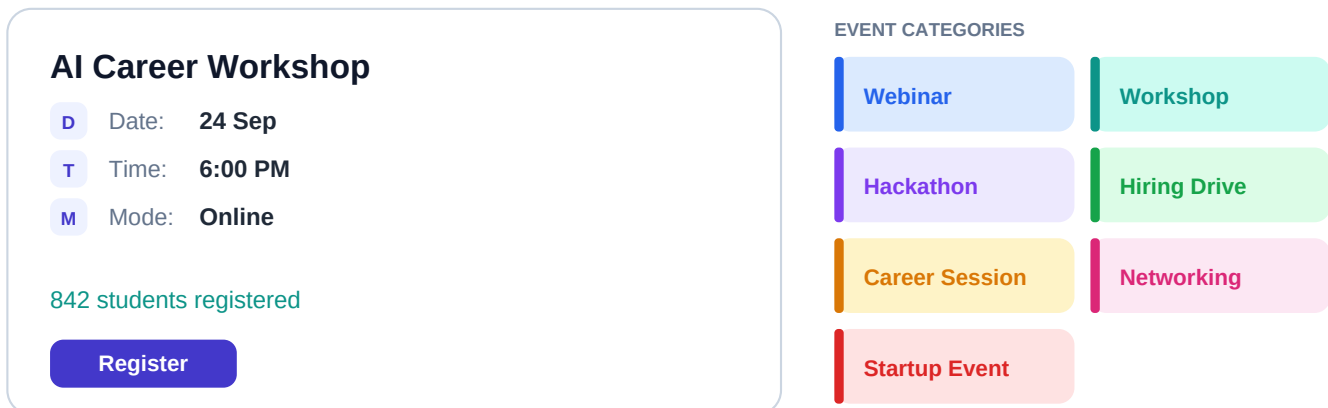


Figure 15 — Event card and the event categories

This fits the document's event model, including hackathons, workshops, webinars, recruitment drives and international opportunity sessions.

14 Mentorship

Mentorship should be visible, but kept **below Events** in the initial version.

Submenu

[Discover Mentors](#)[My Mentors](#)[Sessions](#)

M

Mentor Name
Senior ML Engineer

8 years experience

[AI](#) [ML](#) [GenAI](#) [Python](#)

★ 4.8

[View Profile](#)

MVP FLOW (READ-ONLY)

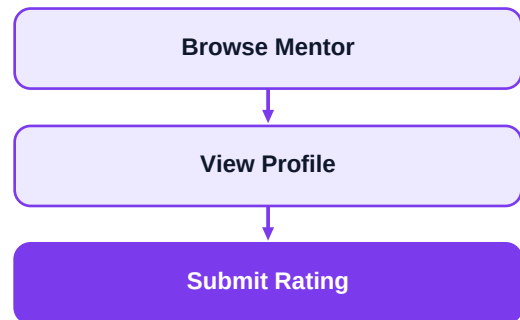


Figure 16 — Mentor card and the MVP flow

MVP SCOPE

The roadmap says mentorship will initially be **read-only**, so don't build a complex mentor-management interface yet.

The guidelines describe mentor profiles, expertise, mentorship requests, sessions, activities and feedback as part of the eventual mentor platform.

15 Notifications

Don't call this *Announcements* — announcements and notifications are different. Use **Notifications**.

3

Bell with unread count

●

Your application was shortlisted
AI Engineer Intern
10 min ago

●

New project invitation
AI Research Project
1 hour ago

●

Event reminder
AI Career Workshop
Tomorrow

[View all notifications →](#)

NOTIFICATION TYPES

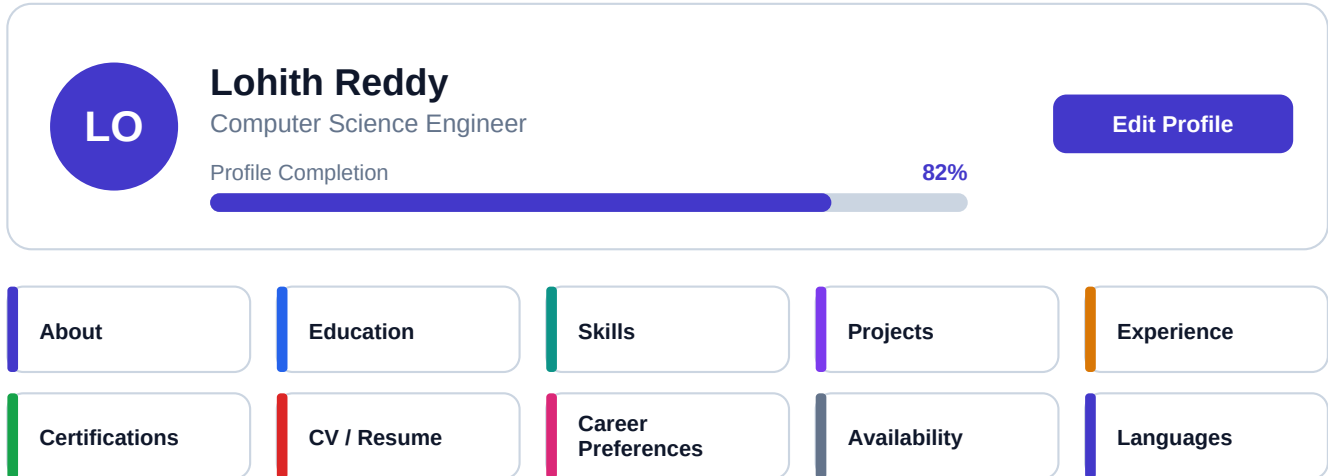
- Application updates
- Project invitations
- Event reminders

Figure 17 — Notification bell and dropdown

The platform guidelines include a communication and notification system as a core module.

16 Profile

This should **not** be buried inside Settings. For a career platform, the profile is a major product feature — place **My Profile** near the bottom of the sidebar, outside Settings.



The profile page header for Lohith Reddy, a Computer Science Engineer, shows a profile completion progress bar at 82% and an 'Edit Profile' button. Below the header are ten sections: About, Education, Skills, Projects, Experience, Certifications, CV / Resume, Career Preferences, Availability, and Languages. Each section is represented by a card with a colored vertical bar on the left.

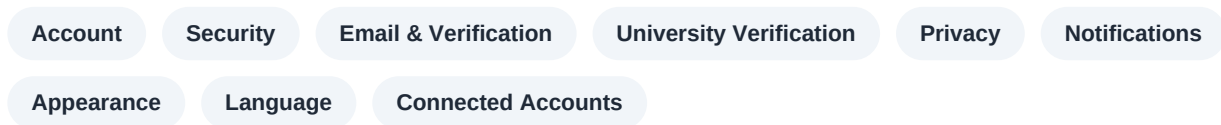
Section	Color
About	Blue
Education	Blue
Skills	Teal
Projects	Purple
Experience	Orange
Certifications	Green
CV / Resume	Red
Career Preferences	Pink
Availability	Grey
Languages	Blue

Figure 18 — Profile page header and sections

This follows the profile fields described in the document: education, technical skills, soft skills, experience, projects, certifications, preferred roles, locations, availability, languages and career interests.

17 Settings

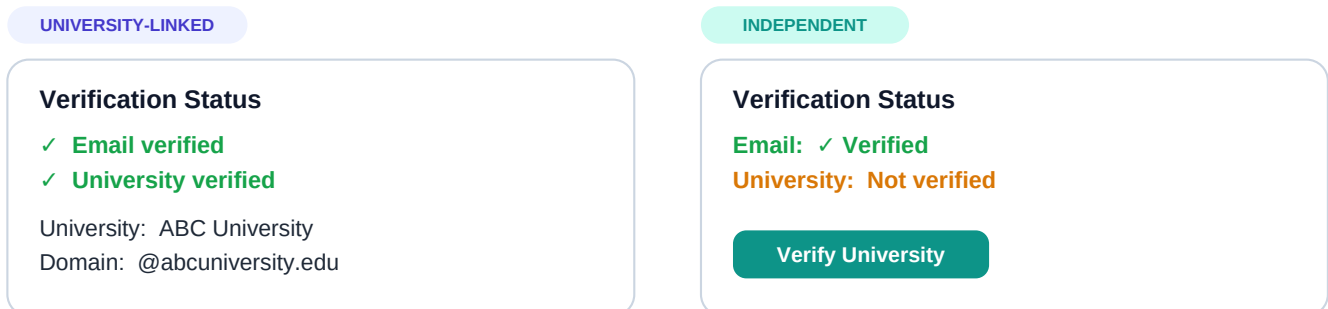
Keep Settings simple.



The settings page features a horizontal row of ten settings categories: Account, Security, Email & Verification, University Verification, Privacy, Notifications, Appearance, Language, and Connected Accounts. Each category is represented by a rounded rectangle with a colored border.

Setting Category	Color
Account	Blue
Security	Blue
Email & Verification	Blue
University Verification	Blue
Privacy	Blue
Notifications	Blue
Appearance	Blue
Language	Blue
Connected Accounts	Blue

University Verification is especially important



The verification status comparison shows two scenarios: University-Linked and Independent. The University-Linked scenario shows a verified status with a green checkmark and a 'Verify University' button. The Independent scenario shows an unverified status with an orange checkmark and a 'Verify University' button.

Verification Status	Details
UNIVERSITY-LINKED	✓ Email verified ✓ University verified University: ABC University Domain: @abcuniversity.edu
INDEPENDENT	✓ Email: Verified University: Not verified Verify University

Figure 19 — Verification status — university-linked vs. independent user

18 Help & Support

Keep this at the bottom of the sidebar.

[Help Center](#)[Report a Problem](#)[Report an Opportunity](#)[Community Guidelines](#)[Contact Support](#)

The Community Guidelines should be accessible here. The document establishes professional communication, anti-harassment expectations, accurate information, confidentiality, legitimate opportunities, IP protection and grievance reporting.

19 The Most Important Change: Don't Show Every Submenu Permanently

This is important for UI cleanliness. If every submenu is expanded at once, the sidebar becomes huge. Instead show a clean first level, and expand a section only when the user clicks it.

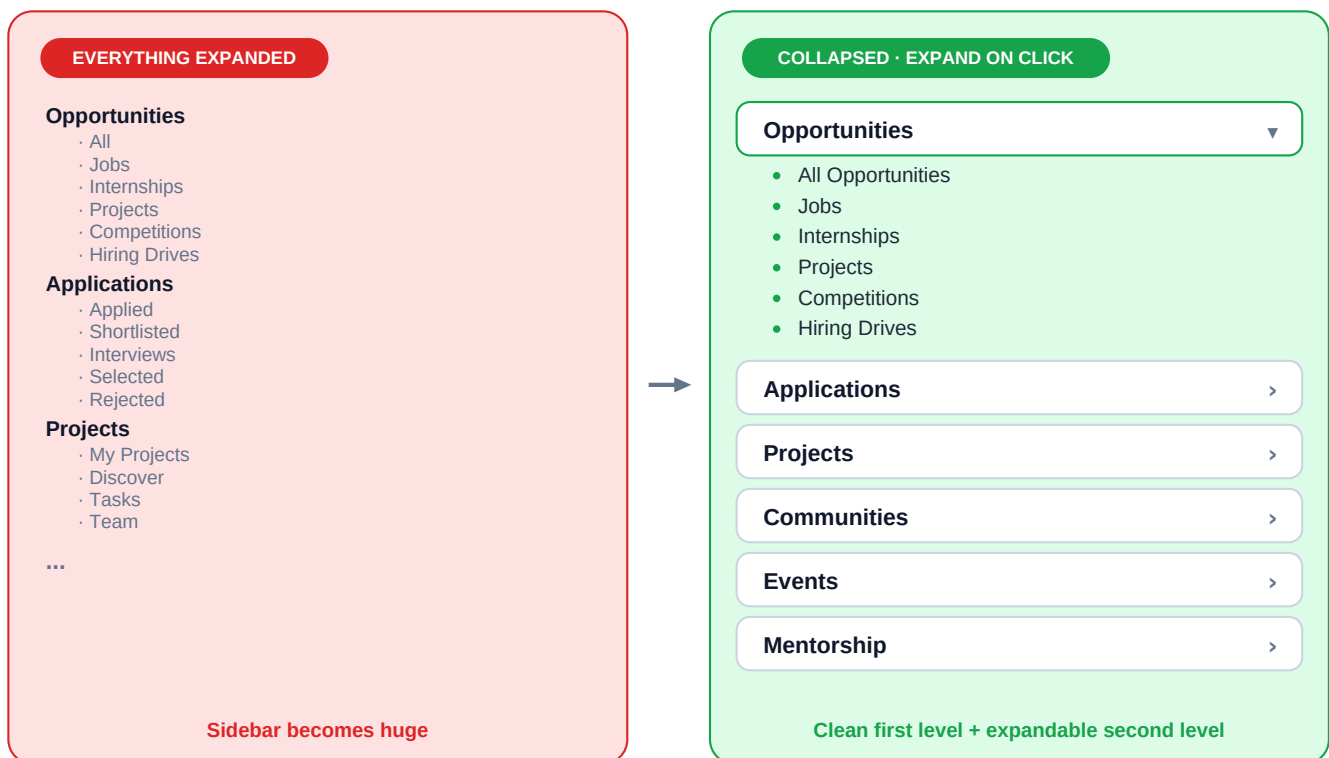


Figure 20 — Expanded-everything sidebar vs. collapsed sidebar

20 Recommended Sidebar Ordering

Use this exact order:

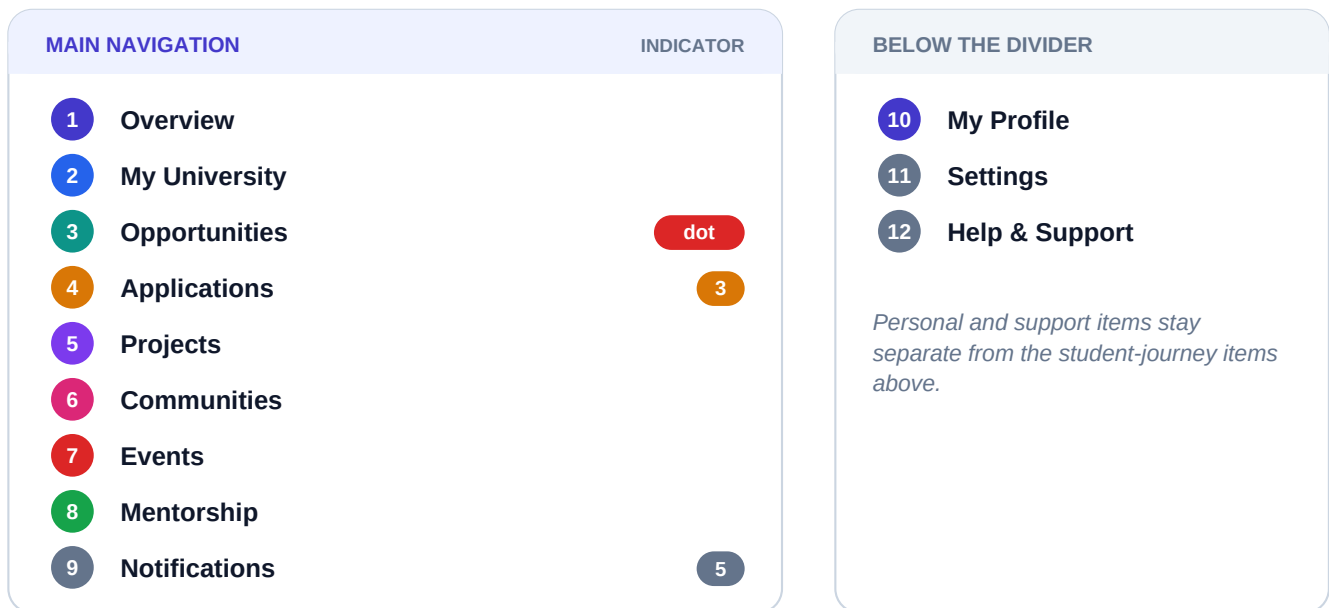


Figure 21 — Recommended order of the sidebar items

Why this order?

Because the student's journey is approximately:



Figure 22 — The student journey the ordering follows

21 Make the Sidebar “Smart”

This is where GenZnect becomes more engaging. Instead of static navigation, show contextual information so the platform feels alive.

Sidebar item	Contextual information shown
Opportunities	12 new
Applications	3 active
Projects	2 active
Events	4 upcoming
Notifications	5 new

22 Profile Completion Indicator

Under the user's name, show a compact progress bar (**Profile 82% · Complete profile →**). When clicked, it opens the checklist below.

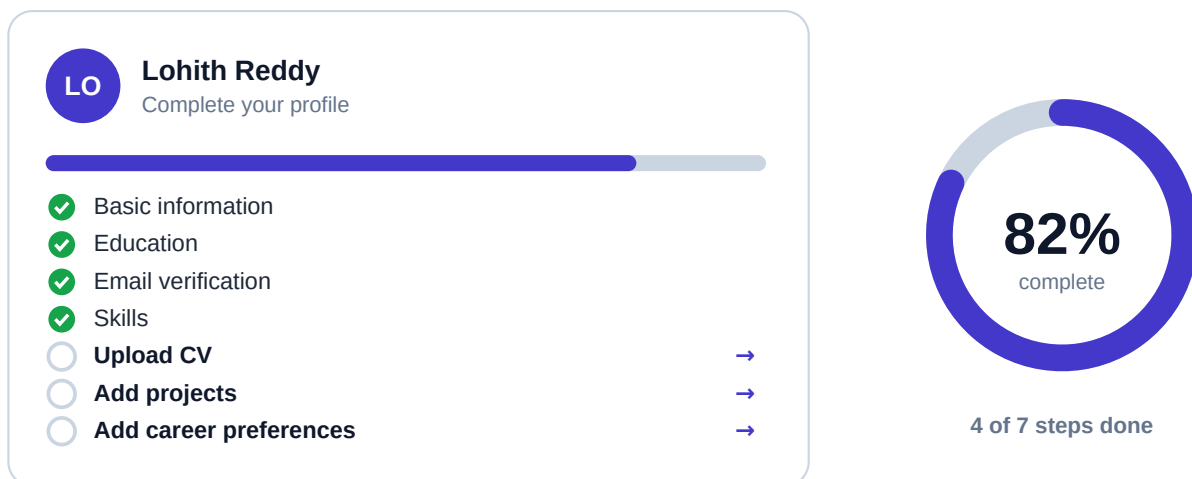


Figure 23 — Profile-completion checklist

This is particularly valuable during onboarding because the document explicitly includes profile completion, CV upload, skills / interests, preferred industry / role and availability.

23 Add “For You” Intelligence

Later, GenZnect can personalize the dashboard. Instead of only *Opportunities*, it could say “**12 new for you**”. The recommendation engine would consider:

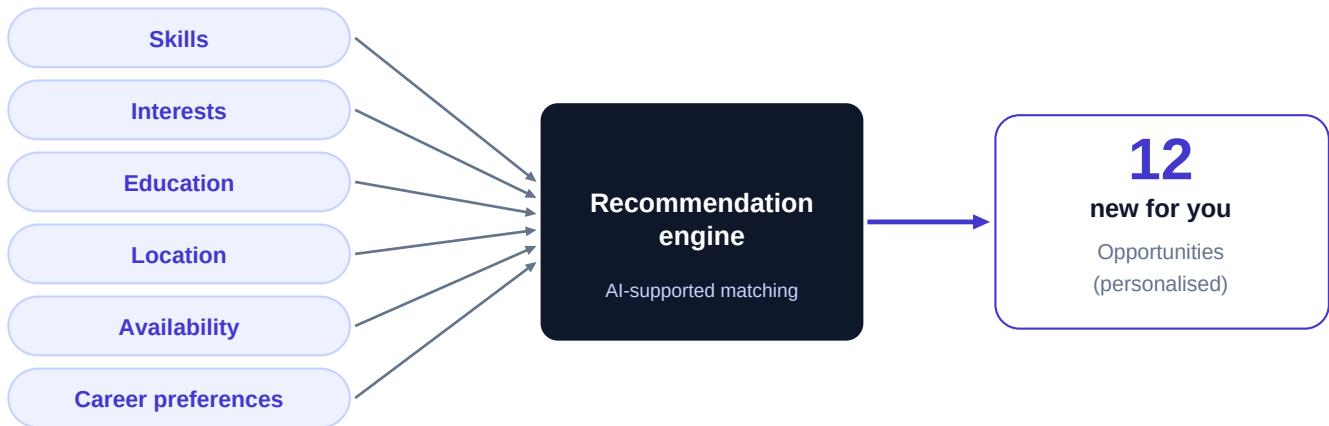


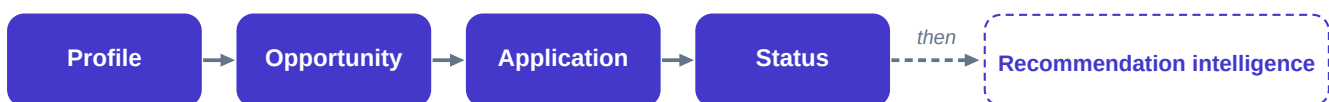
Figure 24 — Inputs to the future recommendation engine

The guidelines explicitly identify AI-supported candidate matching as a future platform module.

BUILD ORDER

Don't build sophisticated AI matching in the first version. Build Profile → Opportunity → Application → Status first, then add recommendation intelligence.

BUILD ORDER



First version: solid line. Later: dashed box.

Figure 25 — First version vs. later recommendation intelligence

24 Right Panel — Recommended Design

Make the right panel **dynamic** rather than copying the right side of the LMS screenshot. Use four short, actionable cards:

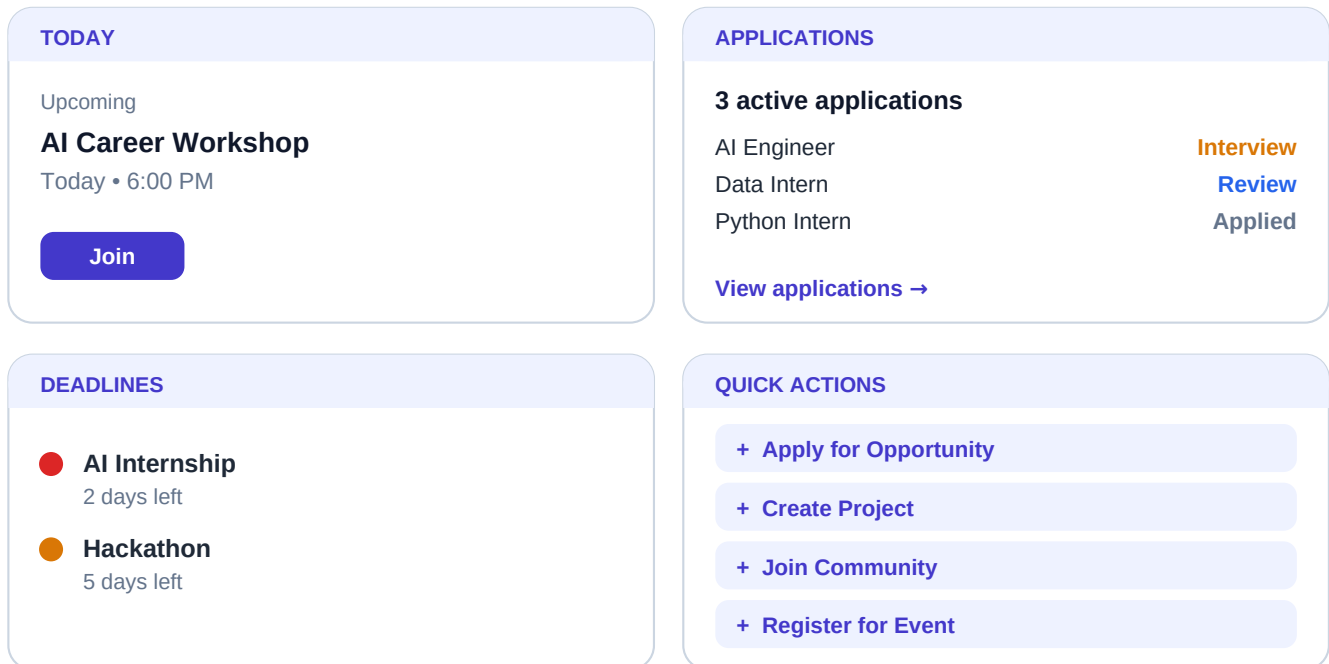
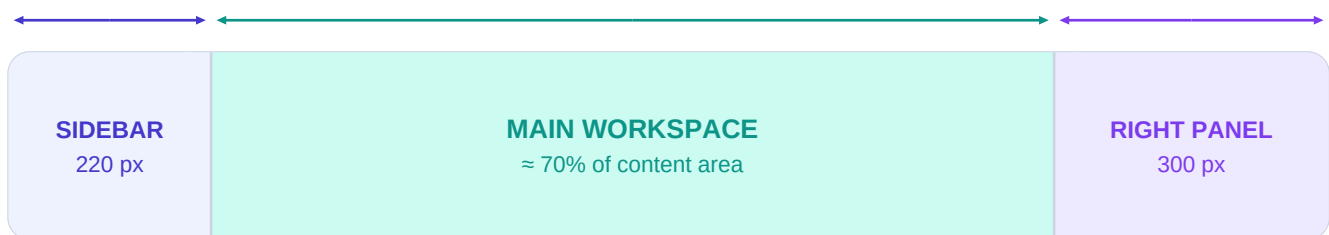


Figure 26 — Right-panel cards (stacked vertically in the actual UI)

25 Don't Make the Right Panel Too Large

The second screenshot has a lot of empty space. For GenZnect, keep the proportions below.



Main content = 70% • Right panel = 30% (short, actionable information — not another dashboard)

Figure 27 — Recommended layout proportions

The right panel should contain **short, actionable information**, not another dashboard.

26

Make the Dashboard Feel Like a Career Workspace

The Overview should eventually look something like this — much more engaging than simply displaying courses.

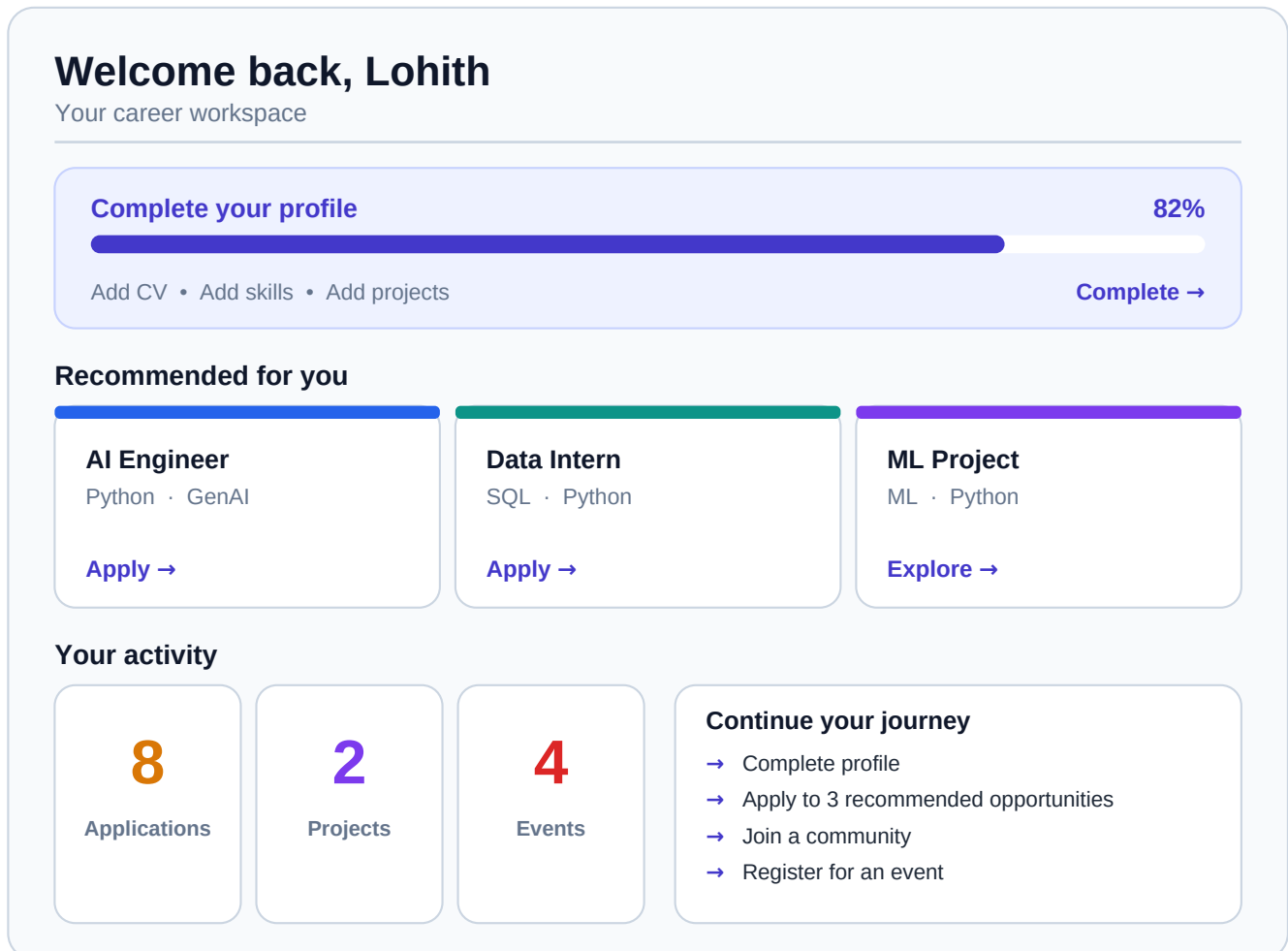


Figure 28 — Target Overview page

27 Student Engagement Loop

This is probably the most important product concept for GenZnect. You don't want the student to log in only when they need a job. You want a loop:

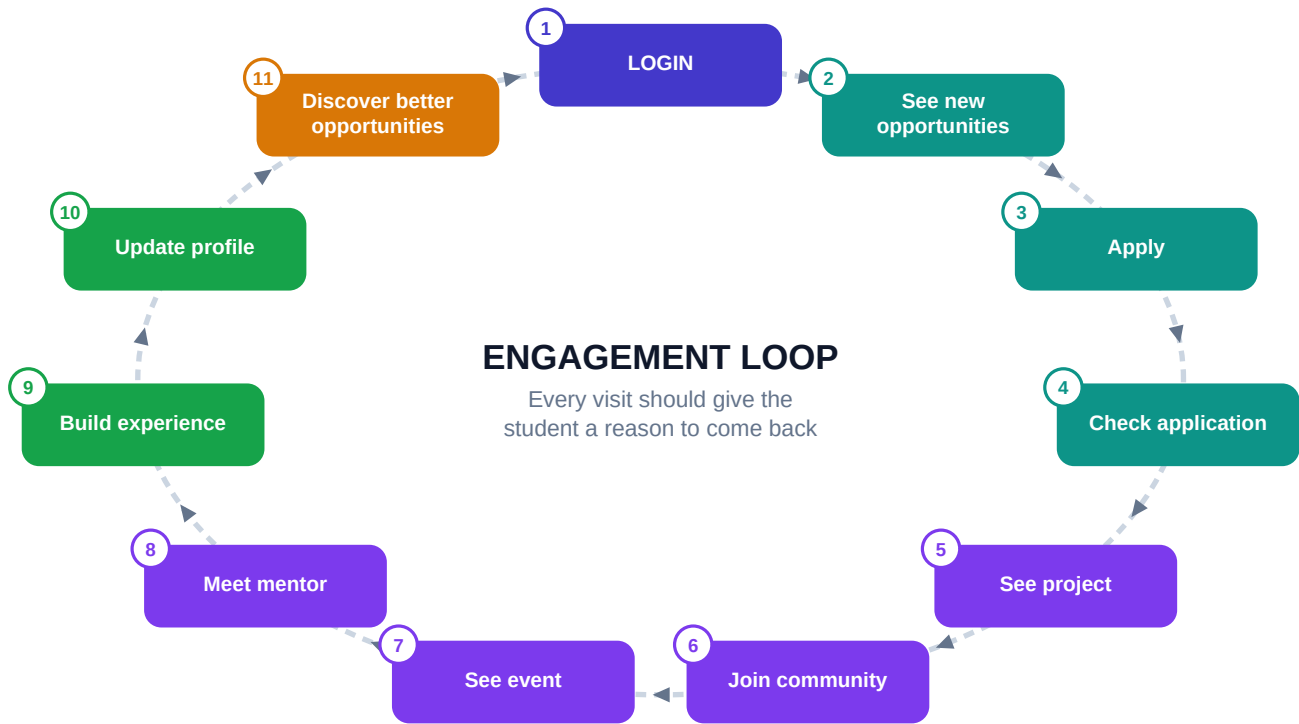


Figure 29 — The student engagement loop

This is consistent with the guidelines' emphasis on daily / weekly opportunity updates, technical challenges, career discussions, networking, mentor interactions, resume activities, mock interviews and project reviews.

28 Your MVP Should NOT Build Everything Yet

Keep the sidebar visually capable of supporting the future modules, but only **activate what is actually implemented**.

PRODUCT ROADMAP



PHASE 1 FOCUS — THE ENTRY FLOW

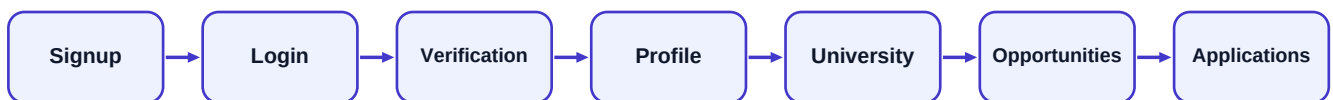


Figure 30 — Phased roadmap and the Phase 1 entry flow

Phase	Modules	Features / focus
1 — NOW	Overview, My University, Opportunities, Applications, Profile, Notifications, Settings	Signup → Login → Verification → Profile → University → Opportunities → Applications
2	Projects	Create project · Invite teammates · Tasks · Progress · Files
3	Communities	Discover · Join · Feed · Posts · Comments
4	Events	Events module
5	Mentorship	Initially read-only, as specified
6	Notifications (expand)	Across Applications, Projects, Communities, Events, Mentorship and University

29 One Important UX Rule

Don't show unavailable modules as if they were functional. If Projects isn't implemented, don't let the user click it and land on "Coming soon..." everywhere. Instead, either add a subtle **BETA** tag, or don't display the item until its phase is ready.

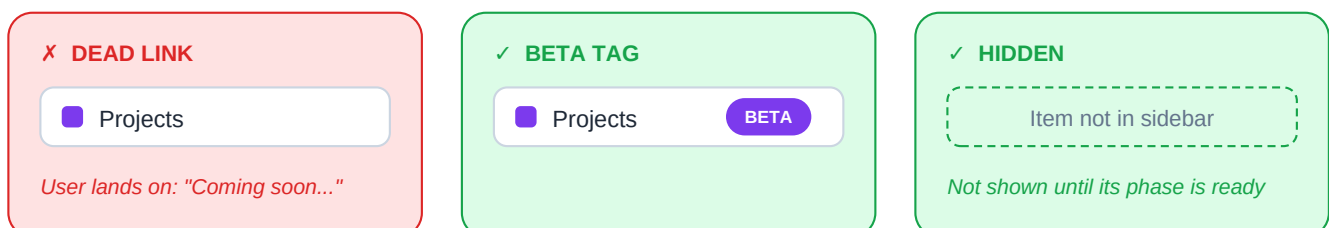


Figure 31 — Handling modules that are not implemented yet — this makes GenZnect feel like a real product, not a prototype with dead links

30 Final Sidebar I Recommend for Your Current Build

If the team is implementing the dashboard right now, use exactly this structure: a clean first level plus expandable second-level items.

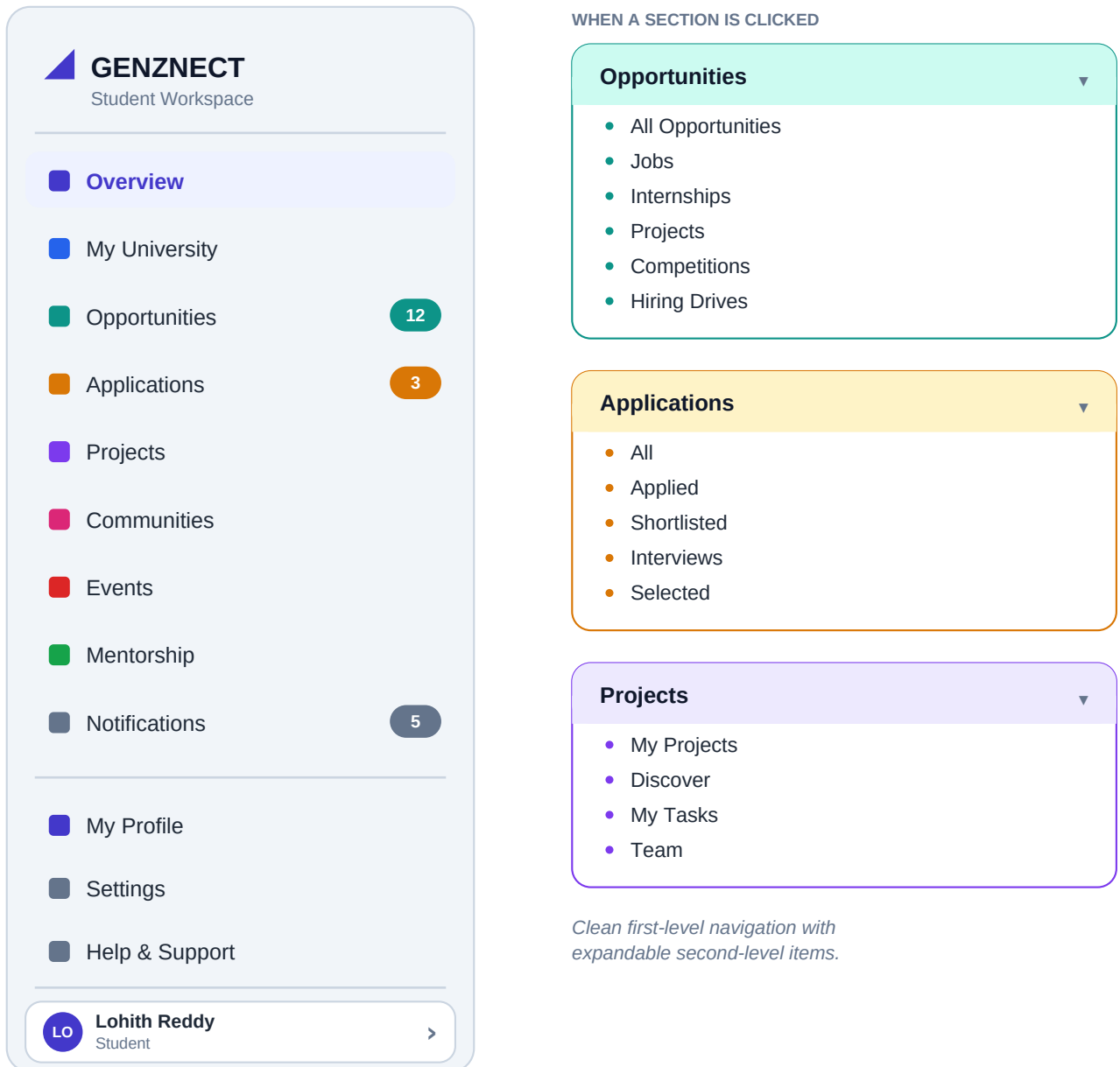


Figure 32 — Final sidebar and its expanded states

NOTE

Modules that are not built yet (see Phase 1 in Section 28) should follow the rule in Section 29 — tagged BETA or hidden until ready.

31 GenZnect's Sidebar Philosophy

The sidebar is defined around the student's core jobs — each section answers one question.

Student need	GenZnect section
Where am I?	Overview
Where do I belong?	My University
What can I get?	Opportunities
What happened to my applications?	Applications
What am I building?	Projects
Who can I connect with?	Communities
What is happening?	Events
Who can guide me?	Mentorship
What needs my attention?	Notifications
What represents me?	Profile

That is the core identity of the platform. The long-term guidelines also position it as something broader than a social-media community: a structured ecosystem combining opportunities, projects, recruitment, mentoring, events and technology in one place.

★ Recommended Overall Architecture

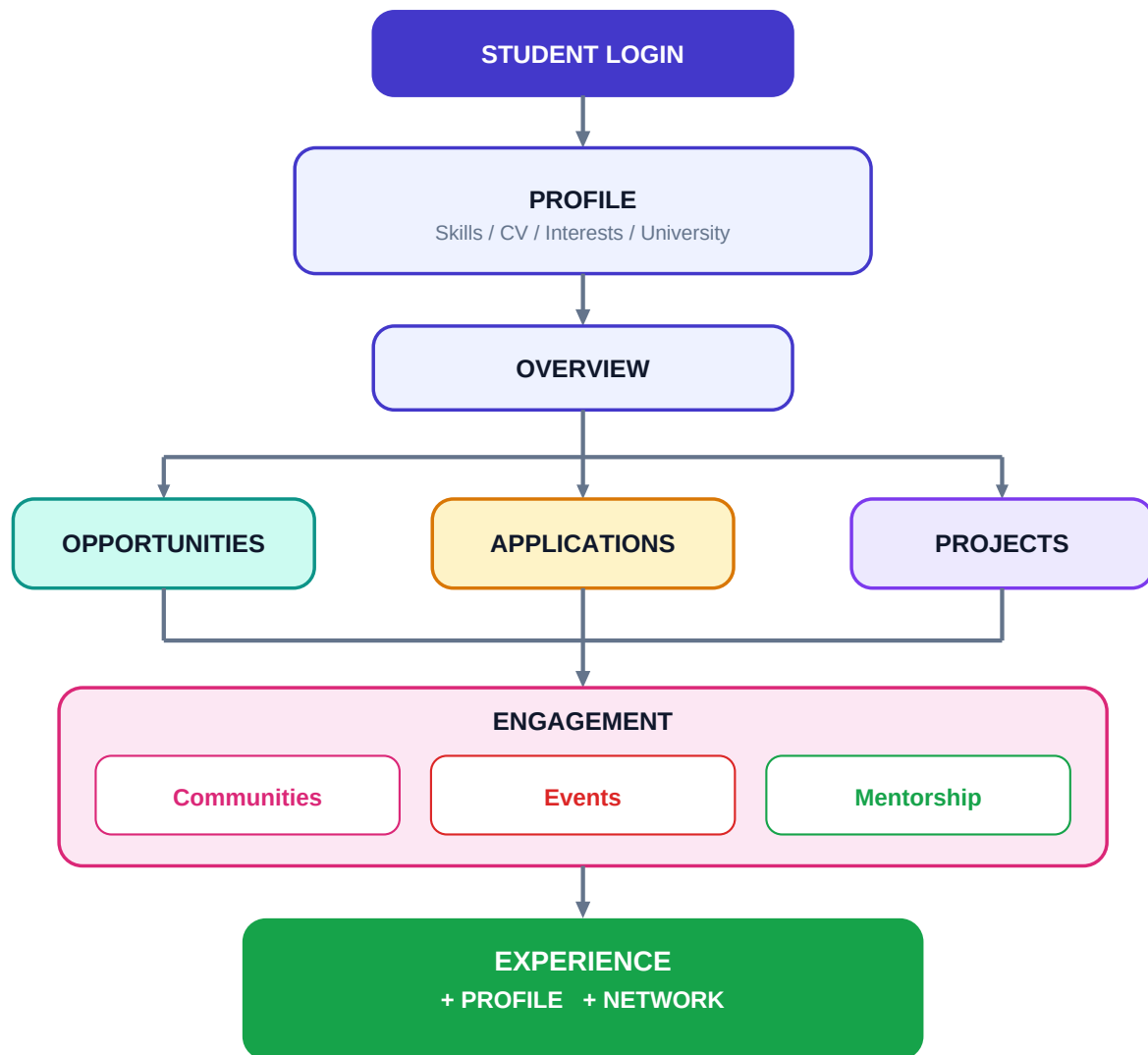


Figure 33 — End-to-end architecture of the student portal

DIRECTION

Keep the left navigation extremely focused on the student's journey, make **Opportunities** → **Applications** → **Projects** the central product loop, and use the right panel for deadlines, application updates, upcoming events and quick actions rather than generic information.